BEFORE THE NUMBERS

StartPad — Business Model Canvas

Egypt and Saudi Arabia · the model the financial model is built to count · October 2026 onwards

01 Key Partners

Certified delivery partners
INJAZ Egypt, Misr El Kheir, Life Makers, regional training providers — they run cohorts under licence and keep 40% of the fee

Youth and channel organisations
Enactus Egypt, INJAZ, Hult Prize chapters, AIESEC — campus footprint StartPad will never build itself

Government and initiative owners
Rowad 2030, MSMEDA, ITIDA, Ministry of Technical Education · Monsha'at, TVTC, Misk, Hadaf

Donors and international organisations
ILO (Start and Improve Your Business), UNDP, GIZ, UNICEF, British Council, Drosos, Sawiris

Competition sponsors
Orange Egypt, ExxonMobil Egypt, National Bank of Egypt, Banque Misr, Central Bank FinYology

Universities and incubators
AUC Venture Lab, Nahdet El Mahrousa, university entrepreneurship centres

Bought, not hired
Accounting and legal firms, the Mission Zero freelance crew, the Arabic translation panel, safeguarding accreditation

02 Key Activities

- Own the standard: curriculum in three variants, assessment, certification and audit
- Certify facilitators and partner organisations — then audit them every term
- Deliver cohorts through the certified network, not through employees
- Operate competitions: entry, qualification, mentor matching, judging
- Produce Mission Zero — three seasons a year, twelve episodes each
- Build the platform and the bilingual AI mentor
- Institutional business development across six buyer types
- Write bids, proposals and donor logframes

03 Key Resources

- The platform: 15 missions, AI co-founder, 121 mapped tools, admin workspace, per-participant evidence record
- Bilingual MENA curriculum — university, school and technical variants
- The certification standard and assessment, which is the defensible asset
- The certified facilitator pool and partner network
- Institutional relationships and the cohort evidence record
- The Mission Zero library and the annual readiness report
- A capped team: 6 people in year one rising to 20 in year five

04 Value Propositions

To the young person — a method, not advice
Fifteen sequenced missions where the next one opens only when the last passes review. An AI co-founder inside every mission. Not a course: a path with a gate.

To the university or school — the outcome they are measured on
Employability and entrepreneurship results they are accountable for and have no way to produce, delivered and evidenced, with a cohort report per student.

To the ministry or initiative — delivery capacity they do not own
A published target of a million entrepreneurs needs a build stage and a per-participant record. Trainer certification is the only version of this that reaches national scale.

To the donor — indicators, not activities
An evidence record their monitoring function accepts without re-work, mapped to the ILO methodology they already use.

To the sponsor — something to report
A decade of funding competitions has produced attendance figures and photographs. We give a measurable outcome per participant and a report they can publish.

To the partner organisation — a standard to deliver under
Curriculum, platform, certification and audit. They keep the relationship and the larger share of the fee.

05 Customer Relationships

Land and expand
Funded pilot → delivered cohort → faculty or school licence → renewal. The report, not the pitch, is the sales document.

Certified licence, with an audit that bites
Partners are certified, sampled each term, and can lose the licence

Named account management
Renewals owned from year five; before that, by the signing head

Community and standing
Ambassadors earn status; founders appear on Mission Zero

Resident in Saudi Arabia
A country manager in Riyadh — the relationship precedes the product

06 Channels

Offline — these create sign-ups and leads
Campus workshops · ambassador network · competitions · events and fairs · partner sessions · direct outreach by the heads

Online — these create reach
Short video (TikTok, Instagram, Facebook) · paid social · influencers and student creators · Mission Zero · webinars · SEO and content

One destination
Every channel lands on Mission 01. Activation is finishing it, not opening an account.

Institutional route
Enter at the edge — one campus, one branch, one chapter — never at head office

07 Customer Segments

WHO PAYS

Universities and faculties
Entrepreneurship centres, capstone coordinators, deans, student activities

Schools and technical institutes
Private, international and applied-technology schools; TVET colleges

National initiatives and government
Ministries, agencies and programme offices with published targets

NGOs, donors and foundations
With a youth employability or entrepreneurship mandate and a budget

Competition sponsors and corporates
Banks, telcos and CSR or innovation budget holders

Incubators and accelerators
Buying better-prepared applicants, per seat

WHO USES IT

First-time founders, 18-30
Students and graduates with an idea or a graduation project

Secondary and technical students, 15-18
Reached through schools, never sold to directly

Micro and small enterprise owners
Reached through banks, NGOs and government programmes

08 Cost Structure

Direct — moves with every cohort and seat
Facilitator fees (certified freelancers, never employees) · materials and showcases · seat provisioning, support and AI inference · competition and event delivery · programme delivery

Revenue share — three counterparties
Certified delivery partners on partner-delivered cohorts · youth and channel organisations on competitions and programme seats · aggregators and payment processing on initiative seats and subscriptions

Indirect — does not move with a cohort
Payroll for a capped team · offline and online marketing · Mission Zero production · rent and utilities · cloud and AI · travel · outsourced finance, legal and audit · safeguarding · partner enablement and audit · depreciation and amortisation

09 Revenue Streams

Education
University cohort programmes · faculty licences · school cohorts · school licences · technical and vocational cohorts · programme and incubator seats

Public
National initiative seats, priced per participant · train-the-trainer certification, plus the per-seat licence behind every certified trainer · NGO and donor programmes

Commercial
Sponsored competitions · corporate and CSR programmes · Mission Zero season and episode sponsorship

Direct
Founder subscriptions — Pro and Team. The smallest line, and a consequence of the other engines rather than a channel of its own

Somebody other than the beneficiary pays in every stream but the last. That asymmetry is the business model.

WHAT THE FINANCIAL MODEL WILL COUNT

Acquisition architecture

Six buyer types, every channel offline and online, and the three-stage funnel each one runs through

THE FUNNEL — THREE STAGES, MEASURED SEPARATELY

SPEND
Cost per click

Budget by channel ÷ CPC = paid clicks. Organic and referral traffic are then taken as a stated percentage of paid, never assumed free.

STAGE 1
Click → lead

A click becomes a lead: an identified person or institution. Rate differs by channel — a webinar registrant is not a video view.

STAGE 2
Lead → registered account

A lead opens an account on the platform. For institutions this is the meeting-to-proposal step instead.

STAGE 3
Registered → paid

The account converts: a subscription for a founder, a signed contract for an institution, a seat order for a funder.

SIX BUYER TYPES — EACH WITH ITS OWN CHANNELS, CYCLE AND UNIT

INSTITUTIONS

Universities, schools, technical institutes

CHANNELS
Campus workshops · direct outreach by the heads · events and conferences · ambassador intelligence · inbound from content

FUNNEL
Lead → first meeting → proposal or funded pilot → signed contract

UNIT SOLD
Sold per cohort, then per faculty or school licence

MODEL DRIVER
Offline activity and inbound produce leads; three conversion stages with a four-month lag give contracts signed. Contracts x deliveries per contract = cohorts; cohorts x the year's price.

4-month cycle

SPONSORS

Banks, telcos, corporates funding competitions

CHANNELS
Competition organisers introduce them · direct outreach · the annual readiness report · LinkedIn and the decision-maker cut of Mission Zero

FUNNEL
Lead → brief → season proposal → sponsorship contract

UNIT SOLD
Sold per competition season, and per Mission Zero season

MODEL DRIVER
Competition seasons a year x the season fee, plus Mission Zero seasons x the sponsorship fee. The driver is the number of sponsors won, never audience size.

3-5 month cycle, annual calendar

NGOs AND DONORS

Foundations, INGOs, development agencies

CHANNELS
Partner sessions inside their cohorts · donor events · the ILO methodology mapping · existing grantees

FUNNEL
Design-phase conversation → named in the proposal → grant awarded → delivery

UNIT SOLD
Sold as a programme, against a logframe

MODEL DRIVER
Proposals entered at design phase x win rate, lagged twelve to eighteen months. Programmes won x the programme fee, delivered across several sites.

12-18 months, must start early

GOVERNMENT INITIATIVES

Ministries, agencies, national programmes

CHANNELS
Enter through one university, one governorate branch or one patronised competition — never head office

FUNNEL
Funded pilot → cohort report → priced seat block → trainer certification

UNIT SOLD
Sold per seat, then per certified trainer

MODEL DRIVER
Funded pilots open seat blocks: seats a quarter x price per seat. Then certification cohorts x fee, and the per-seat licence every certified trainer carries behind them.

9-15 months

CSR AND CORPORATE

Innovation and CSR budget holders

CHANNELS
A reference programme a committee can circulate · sponsor relationships · corporate volunteer networks

FUNNEL
Lead → case study → CSR committee → annual budget line

UNIT SOLD
Sold as a custom programme

MODEL DRIVER
Reference programmes produce annual budget lines; budget lines won x the programme fee, on the corporate budget calendar.

Annual budget cycle

B2C FOUNDERS

Students, graduates, micro-enterprise owners

CHANNELS
Short video · paid social · influencers · Mission Zero · webinars · SEO — and, far more productively, the cohorts, seats and competitions the other five buyers pay for

FUNNEL
Click → free account → Mission 01 activation → Pro or Team

UNIT SOLD
Sold per subscription, annual plan

MODEL DRIVER
Two sources, modelled apart: the reach the other five buyers have already paid for, and an online funnel of spend / CPC -> click -> lead -> account -> paid. Annual plans billed up front, recognised monthly, churned monthly.

Days, not months

Every stream but the last is paid for by somebody other than the person who benefits. The financial model therefore drives B2C subscriptions from the reach the other five buyers have already paid for, plus an online funnel of its own — never from a standalone consumer budget.

WHAT THE FINANCIAL MODEL WILL SCHEDULE

Activity catalogue

What is actually sold, how long each one runs, and which engine it feeds

Activity	Duration	How it is sold	Engine
University cohort	6 delivery days across 2 weeks; report issued within 5 working days	Per cohort of 25	Engine 1
School cohort	4 delivery days across 2 weeks	Per cohort of 30	Engine 2
Technical and vocational cohort	5 delivery days across 2 weeks	Per cohort of 30	Engine 2
Faculty licence	12 months, renewable	Per faculty, per year	Engine 1
School licence	12 months, renewable	Per school, per year	Engine 2
National initiative seat block	12-month seat licence per participant; provisioned in tranches	Per seat	Engine 3
Train-the-trainer certification	5-day certification plus one supervised delivery — about one quarter	Per certification cohort, plus a per-seat licence behind every trainer	Engine 3
NGO or donor programme	6 to 9 months, usually several sites	Per programme, against a logframe	Engine 4
Sponsored competition season	3 to 5 months: entry, campus rounds, a build cohort between rounds, then the final	Per season, paid by the sponsor	Engine 5
Corporate or CSR programme	3 to 6 months	Per programme	Engine 6
Programme and incubator seats	12-month partner agreement, seats drawn per intake	Per seat	Engine 7
Mission Zero season	12 episodes over about 16 weeks; three seasons a year	Per season or per episode, to a sponsor	Engine 5 / demand
Founder subscription	Annual plan, billed in advance, recognised monthly	Per account — Pro or Team	Engine 8
Facilitator certification	Observe, co-deliver, then one scored supervised delivery; recertified each term	A cost, not a revenue line	Capacity
Partner organisation certification	A certification cohort plus one supervised delivery — about a quarter; audited on sample each term	A cost, and the licence that follows	Capacity
Campus ambassador term	One academic term; roughly 7 active months a year	A stipend, not a salary	Demand
Annual readiness report	Published once a year, with a quarterly data note	A cost that opens institutional doors	Demand

Duration matters because it decides when cash arrives, not only when work happens. A donor programme contracted in one quarter is delivered across the next three; a competition season is bought once a year or not at all; an annual subscription is collected up front and earned a month at a time. The financial model schedules each of these on its own clock rather than spreading everything evenly.

WHERE THE DEMAND ALREADY EXISTS

Named programmes

The real programmes each engine attaches to — targets, not signed partners, and no revenue is attributed to any one of them

Programme	Market	What it already runs	Cadence	What StartPad supplies
Rowad 2030 — One Million Entrepreneurs	Egypt	Ministry of Planning and Economic Development. A three-stage online curriculum with the Rowad Meter data platform; universities including Alexandria have signed protocols funding seats.	Running to 2030	Seats, then trainer certification
MSMEDA governorate programme	Egypt	Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise Development Agency — service centres across the governorates.	Continuous	Seats and certification
ITIDA and the Ministry of Communications	Egypt	National digital-skills and youth-innovation programmes; patron of Startup Teen.	Annual cycles	Seats
Central Bank of Egypt — FinYology	Egypt	More than thirty Egyptian universities; FinTech Got Talent is its annual showcase, now in its third edition.	Annual, academic year	Build cohorts, then the season
Applied technology schools reform	Egypt	Ministry of Technical Education and Training — technical secondary schools converting, with employer partners.	Multi-year	Cohorts, then trainer certification
Enactus Egypt National Competition	Egypt	Thirty to thirty-five university teams reach the national final. Orange Egypt has sponsored it for seventeen consecutive years; ExxonMobil Egypt is a long-standing supporter.	Annual season, 4-5 months	Platform and build cohorts
INJAZ Egypt — Company Program	Egypt and the Arab region	A six-month student venture programme with school and university tracks, ending in the Youth Entrepreneurship Celebration, now in its nineteenth edition and feeding INJAZ Al-Arab.	6 months per cycle	Delivery partner licence
Startup Teen (iSchool)	Egypt	Ages 13 to 18, combining entrepreneurship with AI. First edition: 800+ students from 40 schools in 140 teams, under MCIT patronage.	Annual season	School-variant training track
Egypt Entrepreneurship Rally	Egypt	Run with AASTMT and sponsored by the National Bank of Egypt since 2019.	Annual	Platform and the sponsor's report
Rowad Domiat	Egypt	Governorate competition run by the ILO with ICSB, backed by Methanex Egypt, built on the ILO Start and Improve Your Business methodology.	Annual	Platform, and the ILO mapping
Hult Prize on-campus programme	Egypt and KSA	Student competition run through university chapters, campus rounds feeding regional finals.	Annual, campus round 6-10 weeks	Campus round as a cohort
Monsha'at Academy	KSA	The SME authority's online academy — more than two hundred training events across planning, finance, marketing, e-commerce and franchising, with no build stage after them.	Continuous catalogue	Capstone cohorts, then seats
Misk Foundation and the MISK SDG Innovation Competition	KSA	Youth education and entrepreneurship since 2011; the SDG competition is run with UNDP.	Annual	Cohorts, platform, programmes
TVTC	KSA	336,150 trainees across 314 institutions in 2024, under a Vision 2030 mandate connecting training to self-employment.	Academic year	Trainer certification at scale
Hadaf and the Social Development Bank	KSA	Subsidised training and finance for job-seekers and micro-enterprise owners, with per-beneficiary funding already in place.	Continuous	Seat rider, as a screening instrument
Entrepreneurship World Cup — Saudi round	KSA	Global competition with a national Saudi round reaching students and early-stage founders.	Annual	Build track and qualification

The common shape is worth naming: every one of these has a target or a mandate it cannot meet with the delivery capacity it owns. That gap — between a published commitment and the means to deliver it — is the demand this model counts.